



covered award-winning action coordinator Tom Delmar, who has worked on Guy Ritchie's *Snatch*, and London-based swordmaster Richard Ryan, who trained Brad Pitt and Eric Bana for *Troy*, for his fantasy adventure, *Drona*. The film, which has the feel of a medieval epic, hopes to kickstart a new Indian action ethic. Says director Behl: "I think we're quite bored of far-eastern martial arts and audiences are too sophisticated to settle for the old-style *dhishoom-dhishoom*." So in *Drona*, he got Ryan to come down to Sambar in Rajasthan to train Abhishek Bachchan and K.K. Menon in swordfighting, hav-

ing got the weapons custom-made in Johannesburg. "But before that, my action master Shyam Kaushal and I had briefed him on our own sword-based martial arts like Kalaripayat and Chhau," says Behl. He followed the same routine for Priyanka Chopra, for whom Sikh martial arts trainers specialising in 'gatka' were flown down from Jalandhar. As a result, Behl's actors ride, leap over walls and race across deserts. In this time-shifting story, he also got Delmar to coordinate a high-speed car chase in Prague.

Vipul Shah, the producer of the Anees Bazmee-directed Rs 48 crore

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